F06 — Independent Challenge and Review Manual

PSS Acceptance 360 | Version 1.0 | 19 October 2026 | Prepared for possible future authorised discussion

Reviewer kit — designed now; to be administered only by an authorised independent reviewer after the user formally joins PSS and appropriate approval is obtained. Questions are neutral and intentionally allow project termination.

1 Reviewer start-up checklist

- Receive signed commissioning authority; record reviewer independence and conflict disclosures.
- Freeze a versioned source bundle and read original full artefacts rather than summaries alone.
- Receive authorised data-access list and approved sampling/retention plan; never use production secrets in personal copies.
- Agree issue severity, hard-stops, minimum evidence sufficiency and dissent procedure before testing.
- Obtain the complete A–E options matrix including no-build and a common baseline.

2 Standard challenge interview script

Bank economic buyer

- Which existing process do you spend budget to fix and how do you verify its cost?
- What is the maximum amount you could sign for this improvement and who approves it?
- What is the cheapest feasible alternative, including fixing internal operations?
- What contractual service failure would cause you to terminate?

PSS CTO and Operations

- Which relevant functions actually run today and in which environment?
- Can an authorised, read-only event feed independently reproduce bank day-end reconciliation?
- Demonstrate duplicates, late reversals, unknown outcomes and recovery from a missing feed.
- How are tenant segregation, access revocation, source logs and incident handoffs tested?

Legal, CISO and DPO

- What exact PSS licence or third-party permission covers each proposed activity?
- Who is controller/processor, and who may access, retain or transfer payment-event data?
- What 2026 critical infrastructure obligations actually apply to this entity/configuration?
- What certification, scope, scheme letter or acquirer agreement has been checked for validity?

PSS CFO / Bank Finance

- Reconcile projected bank fees to authorised buyer price and bank value ceiling.
- Recalculate zero-bank months, recurring OPEX, implementation cost and 60-month NPV independently.
- What are after-tax ETB nominal NPV, FX exposure, peak funding and viable price switching value?
- Which option wins when sponsor activation slips and the strongest bank withdraws?

Procurement and delivery

- What actual reusable PSS asset has a documented lifecycle cost advantage?
- Was PSS Trading assessed under applicable conflict-of-interest and related-party rules?
- Demonstrate exit/portability including deletion/revocation without upstream bank control loss.
- Which outstanding defect would automatically stop a pilot or contract award?

3 Field protocol for finding contradictory evidence

Challenge sampling must include negative cases: banks that decline sponsorship, merchants who already use alternatives successfully, PSS system failures or functionality absent from production, vendor terms less attractive than assumed, and genuine zero-bank cost cases. Record quote/context, permission, original document link, analytical change, management rebuttal and reviewer conclusion. Never exclude a negative observation because its implication is inconvenient.

4 Example exception and dissent register fields

Field	Reviewer capture instructions
Challenge ID / document	Keep immutable IDs linking to workbook tests and source artefact
Claim / direct evidence	Record the exact proposition and primary document or observed system output
Contradiction	Detail what fails, uncertain denominators and assumptions; no euphemistic "pending" for adverse proof
Impact / hard gate	State affected gate and whether data access, spending or pilot must stop
Response	Capture programme response verbatim with evidence and due date
Independent disposition	Accept / partly accept / reject management response; log reason and accountable sign-off

5 Future assessor sign-off sheet (empty)

Control	Reviewer entry
Assurance firm/function and appointment instrument	
Independence declarations	
Documents tested and cut-off date	
Bank/merchant evidence sample scope	
Technical and security tests executed	
Finance model independently re-performed	
Legal limitations and permissions	
Unresolved hard stops / dissent	
Opinion and alternatives comparison	
Signature and date	

6 Management decision minute template

Decision date: [blank]; meeting authority: [blank]; version of source data: [blank]; independently reviewed option: [A/B/C/D/E/none]; verified hard gates: [blank]; dissent summary: [blank]; approved feasibility spending ceiling: [blank]; authorised information access: [blank]; conditions precedent: [blank]; stop criteria: [blank]; next review date: [blank]. An empty minute is not approval.

7 Handover to F01

F01 must carry forward an explicit matrix for each feasibility dimension (evidence-backed / contradicted / unavailable), the highest-severity unclosed risks, the difference between proposed and passed gates, verified financial outputs if any, reviewer dissent and a choice among approve bounded research, redesign, partner, defer, no investment or stop. Do not assign an aggregate "green" status while even one mandatory legal or security gate is open.

8 Framework references

[PUB-01] The IIA Three Lines Model (2020; official statement) — https://www.theiia.org/en/content/communications/2020/july/20-july-2020-iia-issues-important-update-to-three-lines-model/ (Assurance role separation only)

[PUB-02] Cybersecurity Framework 2.0 (2024) — https://www.nist.gov/publications/nist-cybersecurity-framework-csf-20 (Cyber governance outcome framework, not certification)

[PUB-03] Assessing project feasibility and economic viability — https://ppp.worldbank.org/assessing-project-feasibility-and-economic-viability (Methodological lens on options, bias and risk)

[PUB-04] Official documentations (2026 critical infrastructure rule and standard) — https://www.insa.gov.et/documentations (Sector-level public evidence; PSS application unverified)

[PUB-05] INSA public statement on proclamation No. 1426/2026, 7 Aug 2026 — https://www.insa.gov.et/blog/Critical-Infrastructure-Cybersecurity-Proclamation-Marks-a-Major-Step-Toward-Safeguarding-Ethiopia%27s-Digital-Sovereignty-%E2%80%93-INSA-Director-General-Tigist-Hamid (Finance listed; PSS designation unverified)